

THE HIDDEN WISDOM OF YESHUA

Teachings from the Yeshuan Path

A Gnostic Tao for the Children of Light

Edition 3.0 · October 2026

Written for the Seeker of Gnosis

Copyright © 2025–2026 by Rez Khan
All rights reserved.
The Hidden Wisdom of Yesbua
Edition 3.0

A note on these sayings:
These are new sayings, written in the spirit of the Gospel of Thomas,
the Gospels of Mary and Philip, and the Tao Te Ching.
They are not ancient texts. Each of the eighty-one follows
the matching chapter of the Tao Te Ching;
sources and echoes are listed at the end.

Read one saying slowly. Carry it into your day. Return to it through what you encounter.

For practices to accompany the sayings, see *The Wisdom of Awakening*. For the underlying map of forgetting and remembering, see *The Hidden Architecture*.

Contents

Preface	v
1 The Light Before the World	I
1 The Way That Is Not Seen	1
2 The Two Become One	2
3 The Poverty of the Unknowing	2
4 The Father of Light	3
5 The Powers Question the Soul	3
6 The Hollow Reed	3
7 The Unforced Kingdom	4
8 The Servant at the Feast	4
9 The Teacher Who Does Not Teach	5
2 The Kingdom Within	7
10 The Single Eye	7
11 The Inner and the Outer	7
12 The Lion and the Child	8
13 The Unbinding	8
14 The Return to the Unborn	8
15 The Silence That Speaks	9
16 The Great Stillness	9
17 The Hidden Guide	10
18 When the Way Is Forgotten	10
3 The Garment of Silence	11
19 Beyond the Teachings	11
20 Not of This World	12
21 The Face of the Invisible	12
22 The One Who Is Bent	12
23 The Wind Speaks Briefly	13

24	The Tower That Topples	13
25	The Womb of Silence	13
26	The Heavy Root	14
27	The Footprints of the Master	14
4	The Power of the Gentle	15
28	The Fertile Soil	15
29	The Futility of Control	15
30	The Way of Non-Violence	16
31	The Weapon of the Heart	16
32	The Way, the Truth	17
33	Profit and Loss	17
34	The Great River	18
35	The Face of Peace	18
36	The Paradox of Power	19
5	The Union of Opposites	21
37	The Ease of the Way	21
38	True Virtue	21
39	The Ones Who Remain Whole	22
40	The Return	22
41	The Three Seekers	22
42	The Birth of the Two	23
43	The Gentle Overcomes	23
44	Where the Mind Is	24
45	The Great Fullness	24
6	The Empty Vessel	25
46	The Yoke of Peace	25
47	Seeing Without Seeking	25
48	The Unlearning	26
49	The Heart of the Single One	26
50	Life and Death	26
51	The Nourishing Way	27
52	Return to the Mother	27
53	The Eye of the Needle	27
54	The Unshakable Root	28
7	The Unforced Life	29

55	The Child of the Light	29
56	The One Who Knows	29
57	Lay Down No Law	30
58	Sowing in Winter	30
59	Dig Down to the Root	31
60	Governing by Non-Grasping	31
61	The Great Acceptance	32
62	The Treasure Within	32
63	The Small Actions	33
8	The Wisdom of the Child	35
64	The First Step	35
65	To Each as They Could See	36
66	Leading by Following	36
67	The Three Jewels	37
68	The Peaceful Warrior	37
69	The Sword of the Spirit	38
70	A Teaching Few Understand	39
71	The Gift of Not-Knowing	39
72	The Fear of the False Self	40
9	The Return to Source	41
73	The Courage of the Way	41
74	Rise Before You Die	41
75	Be of Good Courage	42
76	The Green Wood and the Dry	42
77	The Stretched Bow	43
78	The Stone and the Corner	43
79	The End of Debts	43
80	The Simple Kingdom	44
81	The Completion	44
	Sources and Echoes	45
	Glossary of the Inner Kingdom	49
	Colophon	51

Preface

Yeshua spoke:

Beloved,
you wander in search of what has never been lost.
You lift your eyes to heaven,
yet the Kingdom is already laid in your breath.
You seek the Light in scriptures and temples,
yet the Light waits behind your seeing.

If you would know me,
enter the silence where your name has not yet formed.
There the Father of Light whispers,
and the Mother of Wisdom gathers you to Herself.
There the two are made one,
and the one is shown to be none.

Do not follow me as a man follows another man.
Follow the One who moves within your own heart,
for I am that One
when you remember yourself.
And I am hidden from you
only when you forget.

These sayings are not commandments
but mirrors.
Look into them
until you see your own face shining there—
the face you had
before the world divided you.

When you make the inner like the outer,
the above like the below,
the lion like the child,

and the child like the unbegotten,
then the bridal chamber opens,
and you awaken as the Living One.

Come,
remove your old garments.
Step naked into the light of your own being.
There is nothing to fear.
What you take to be your shadow
is only the veil you have outgrown.

Let the scroll unfold within you.
Let the sayings ripen in your silence.
And when the fruit is sweet,
eat and become what you truly are.

May the Inner Sun rise in your heart.



Book 1

The Light Before the World

(Sayings 1-9)

From the Silence, the Word.

From the Word, the Light.

I

THE WAY THAT IS NOT SEEN

The Word caught in ink is a husk;
the Word lived is a devouring fire.
The Kingdom is spread upon the earth,
yet few behold it.
Those who hunt with the eyes
find only shadows.
Those who rest in the still heart
find the Source
from which all seeing springs.

2

THE TWO BECOME ONE

The world is born of the cut in two—
male and female, light and shadow, life and death.
Yet these divisions are garments only.
Truly I say to you:
when the two are made one,
the lion within you lies down as a child,
and the child awakens
as the One who is not born.
Then the bridal chamber opens in your depths.

3

THE POVERTY OF THE UNKNOWING

People cling to the loud voices of the world.
They trust laws more than their own heart,
beliefs more than living knowing.
Thus they sit in a treasury,
yet starve.
One who knows the self
no longer hoards teachings in a scroll.
Their very being becomes the scroll.

4

THE FATHER OF LIGHT

There is a Light that gives birth to itself—
unborn, unbroken, unbound.
From this Light you came;
to this Light you return when you awaken.
The Father bears no wrath.
The Source casts no shadow.
Only the garments of the soul
weave darkness.

5

THE POWERS QUESTION THE SOUL

Desire whispers, “You are mine.”
Ignorance declares, “You do not know yourself.”
Anger cries, “Strike, and be struck.”
The body murmurs, “I am all there is.”
But the awakened soul smiles and replies:
“You never touched me.
You grasped only my clothing.”

6

THE HOLLOW REED

The false self is a wall of stone—
it resists the wind and crumbles.
The soul is a hollow reed—
it lets the Spirit breathe through it.
When you are empty,
even the storm becomes a song.

7

THE UNFORCED KINGDOM

The Kingdom comes by neither effort nor delay.
When you stop grasping at life,
life reveals itself as eternal.
When you cease seeking the Kingdom,
you discover you never left it.
What you call “sin” is forgetting.
What you call “salvation” is remembering.

8

THE SERVANT AT THE FEAST

Be as the servant who seeks the lowest place at the feast.
He does not contend,
yet the Master calls him forward.
So too the one who knows the Father
takes the lowest seat
and finds there the highest.
Humility is not making the self small;
it is seeing that the self is a shadow.

9

THE TEACHER WHO DOES NOT TEACH

I do not command belief.
I uncover what is hidden,
that you may see with your own eyes.
A master gives answers;
I give you questions—
that you may become what I am.



The Kingdom Within

(Sayings 10–18)

The door is shut, yet the house is vast. The lamp is small, yet it lights the world.

IO

THE SINGLE EYE

If the eye of the body is divided,
it sees only confusion.
If the eye of the heart is single,
it fills the whole body with light.
The Nous stands between soul and spirit—
a lamp lit from both sides.
Guard this lamp,
and the night cannot touch you.

II

THE INNER AND THE OUTER

The cup is precious for its emptiness.
So too the self is precious
when it is emptied of self.
Inside and outside are mirrors.
When they reflect without distortion,
the All is revealed.

I2

THE LION AND THE CHILD

The world teaches you to be a lion—
to conquer, to claim, to devour.
But I tell you: unless the lion becomes a child,
you will not know the Living Source.
The child is open, unguarded, whole.
There is no image of self to defend.
Therefore the child steps into the Kingdom easily.

I3

THE UNBINDING

What binds you is not outside you.
What frees you is not outside you.
Prison and key
are fashioned from the same ignorance.
Awaken, and you will laugh—
for there were never any gates.

I4

THE RETURN TO THE UNBORN

Before you were a form, you were the Breath.
Before you were breath, you were the Light.
Before you were the Light,
you were hidden in the Source.
To return is not to go backwards;
it is to remember the place
that has never moved.

15

THE SILENCE THAT SPEAKS

Words are nets thrown into the sea.
They catch small fish,
but the Great Fish slips through.
Do not hunger for many words from me.
Hunger for the Silence
in which the Word is born.
There you and I are one life,
one breath,
one Being.

16

THE GREAT STILLNESS

Empty yourself of what you think you are.
Let the waters of the heart grow still.
When the mud settles by itself,
the bottom is revealed.
So too, when the soul becomes quiet,
the Light of the Living Source
shines through without effort.

I7

THE HIDDEN GUIDE

The greatest guide is the one who disappears.

The seeker awakens and cries:

“Look—

I have found the Way myself.”

Thus I leave no trace,

and yet my footprints are everywhere.

I8

WHEN THE WAY IS FORGOTTEN

When the Living Way is forgotten,

people polish their reputations.

When the heart grows dim,

they multiply rules.

When rules no longer bind,

they threaten with fire

and promise crowns of gold.

The further you flee from your own heart,

the further you stray from Life.

Return to the beginning—

to the spark before words—

and fear falls away

like rotted cloth.



The Garment of Silence

(Sayings 19–27)

The garment divides; the wearer unites.

19

BEYOND THE TEACHINGS

Leave the holiness that needs witnesses;
return to the wholeness
that needs none.
Leave the righteousness that lives in the scroll;
return to the sight
that burns in the heart.
Leave the law that threatens from outside;
return to the Source
that speaks within you as Light.
What you call “good” and “evil”
are shadows thrown by a divided mind.
When the eye becomes single,
the heart needs no commandments.

20

NOT OF THIS WORLD

The world shouts; the Way whispers.
The world demands belief; the Way asks you to see.
The world praises power; the Way dissolves it.
Many chase desires.
Few seek liberation.
Yet the Kingdom belongs to those
who loosen their grip on everything.

21

THE FACE OF THE INVISIBLE

The Way is a child-like mystery—
seen only by those who forget themselves.
It has no beginning and no end.
It moves without moving.
Its face cannot be drawn,
yet it shines through your own face
when you remember who you are.

22

THE ONE WHO IS BENT

If you wish to be whole, let yourself be broken.
If you wish to be full, empty yourself.
If you wish to be reborn, die to your false image.
I do not raise the proud;
I raise only the one
who has laid the self down.

23

THE WIND SPEAKS BRIEFLY

Speak only what is true, and your words will be few.
The wind does not shout;
yet entire forests bow before it.
When you speak from the Living Source,
your words carry no force—
yet they move mountains.

24

THE TOWER THAT TOPPLES

One who raises the self has already fallen.
One who displays virtue has already lost it.
One who demands honor has already betrayed the soul.
Stand in your true nature—
and honor flows from you without asking.

25

THE WOMB OF SILENCE

There is a womb older than creation.
It is the Silence that births the All.
It is formless, unbounded.
It moves through you as breath,
yet it is not the breath.
Those who know Her
do not cling to life nor fear death.

26

THE HEAVY ROOT

The root of the tree is unseen,
yet it holds the whole tree upright.
So too the silent depth of your being
supports your every step.
Those who forget their root
are blown about by every wind—
desire, fear, anger, ignorance.
Remember your depth, and nothing can uproot you.

27

THE FOOTPRINTS OF THE MASTER

A master walks without leaving marks,
speaks without wounding,
guides without controlling:
to the blind, a lamp;
to the lost, a doorway;
to the weary, rest.
Seeing the divine spark in all beings,
the master finds no one beyond help.



The Power of the Gentle

(Sayings 28–36)

The gentle are the strong. The yielding are the immovable.

28

THE FERTILE SOIL

Know the strength of the sower,
yet keep to the softness of the soil—
the fertile field that receives the seed.
Know knowledge, yet return to innocence.
Thus you become the place
where the two become one.

29

THE FUTILITY OF CONTROL

Those who attempt to seize the Kingdom
shatter it in their own hands.
The Kingdom is a living seed,
not an empire of stone.
Force bruises the soil.
Grasping crushes the grain.
But the one who serves the hidden life in all things
finds the harvest rising of itself.

30

THE WAY OF NON-VIOLENCE

Those who walk in the Way do not harm.
They do not conquer.
They do not take up the sword.
For every blow you strike strikes you in return.
Every wound you inflict
becomes your own garment of suffering.
Power gained through violence rots the soul;
power gained through awakening cannot be taken away.

31

THE WEAPON OF THE HEART

Weapons are tools of fear;
the heart of the awakened has no use for them.
Victory through harm is mourning in disguise.
The wise triumph by dissolving conflict,
not by defeating an opponent—
seeing no opponent at all.

32

THE WAY, THE TRUTH

People ask, "Show us the path."

I tell them: **I am the Way.**

People ask, "Show us the doctrine."

I tell them: **I am the Truth.**

People ask, "Show us immortality."

I tell them: **I am the Living One.**

The Way is not a map; it is the Single One walking.

No one comes to the Father of Light
except by becoming what I am.

33

PROFIT AND LOSS

You may read the hearts of others
and still be a stranger to your own.

You may subdue cities
and still be ruled by fear within.

To turn the gaze inward is illumination.

To befriend your own depth is freedom.

For what profit is there in gaining the ten thousand things
if you lose the One who beholds them?

34

THE GREAT RIVER

The River of the Father and the Mother
flows through all worlds,
pouring itself into every vessel,
claiming nothing as its own.
One who walks in this River
acts without self-importance,
gives without calculation,
rests without pride.
Thus they become transparent,
and the Living Source is seen through them.

35

THE FACE OF PEACE

Hold fast to the image of the Living One
and all beings come to rest in your presence.
Peace begins when you see
that the one you oppose
is more than your quarrel.
The awakened do not persuade—they radiate.

36

THE PARADOX OF POWER

To let something expand, first allow it to contract.
To let something grow strong, first allow it to weaken.
A seed must vanish into dark soil,
a breath must empty before it fills.
Thus I guide by reversal,
teaching the soul through its own emptiness.



The Union of Opposites

(Sayings 37-45)

The two become one.

37

THE EASE OF THE WAY

The Way acts without effort.
When the heart aligns with it, desire loosens its grip.
But when desire rises, the soul becomes troubled.
Use the Light to calm the waters,
and they become clear again.

38

TRUE VIRTUE

High virtue moves like breath—
it does not watch itself being virtuous.
Lesser virtue stares into its own reflection,
checking whether it appears upright.
When the Kingdom is remembered,
goodness blossoms of itself.
When it is forgotten,
people invent commandments
to restrain their own hunger.

39

THE ONES WHO REMAIN WHOLE

Heaven remains Heaven because it does not exalt itself.
The earth remains earth because it does not resist its nature.
And the soul remains whole when it refuses to be divided.

40

THE RETURN

The movement of the Way is return—
not to the past, but to the unborn Light within you.
All things rise from the Source,
and the Source rises from silence.

41

THE THREE SEEKERS

The wise hear the living word
and let it cut them to the heart;
they descend gladly into their own poverty.
The many hear it and weigh it like a coin,
spending a little, keeping a little.
The foolish hear it and laugh aloud,
mocking what they have not yet seen.
Yet I tell you:
the Light plays in them all.
The laughers, the traders, the broken ones—
each walks toward the bridal chamber,
though some walk with their backs turned.

42

THE BIRTH OF THE TWO

The Source gives birth to the Father and the Mother.
The Two give birth to the Many.
The Many return to the One.
He who sees the One in every form and motion
cannot be shaken.

43

THE GENTLE OVERCOMES

Truly I say to you:
what is soft and willing
passes where hardness breaks.
Water, patient and lowly,
hollows the rock of ages.
So the soul that yields to the Living One
passes through every barrier
and cannot be imprisoned.

44

WHERE THE MIND IS

Mary asked, "Lord, with what does one see you—
with the soul, or with the spirit?"

I answered: with neither.

There is an eye between them,
and where that eye rests,
there your treasure lies.

Rest it on a name,
and you will starve in a palace.
Rest it on the Light,
and an empty field will feed you.

45

THE GREAT FULLNESS

The cup most full appears most empty.
The path most straight appears crooked.
The hand most skilled holds lightly.
The awakened make peace with paradox
and so are not deceived by appearances.



The Empty Vessel

(Sayings 46–54)

The cup most full appears most empty.

46

THE YOKE OF PEACE

When the Way is lived, the ox knows its master's stall.
When the Way is forgotten, the sword is drawn in the street.
The yoke of the world is heavy with desire.
My yoke is easy, and brings peace.

47

SEEING WITHOUT SEEKING

You cross seas and deserts to seek signs,
yet the Sign looks out through your own eyes.
Without leaving your house,
you may behold the world within you.
Without straining your sight,
you may know the One who sees.
The more you chase what is outside,
the more you forsake the Treasure within.

48

THE UNLEARNING

The scholar gathers more words each day
and builds a tower of opinions.
The seeker of the Way
lays one stone down each day
until only open sky remains.
She strips off garment after garment—
belief, fear, reputation—
until the naked Light stands forth.
He who lets go of all things
discovers that he holds the All.

49

THE HEART OF THE SINGLE ONE

The Single One is good to those who are good,
and good to those who are not good—
seeing only the Light within them.
Trusting those who trust,
and trusting those who do not trust—
for trust flows from the inner being, not theirs.

50

LIFE AND DEATH

Those who cling to life fear death.
Those who know Me fear neither.
Death is but the undressing of the bride
before she enters the chamber.

51

THE NOURISHING WAY

The Way gives birth, nourishes, guides, protects,
and does so without claiming ownership.
Thus the Single One completes the work and forgets the work—
and it remains forever.

52

RETURN TO THE MOTHER

Know the Mother of your soul,
and you recognize all her children.
Know the children as passing forms,
and you are drawn back to the Mother.
In returning to the Womb of Light
you are no longer wounded by the powers,
for you remember that you were never separate
from the One who birthed you.

53

THE EYE OF THE NEEDLE

The world says, “Strive to enter the narrow gate.”
But I tell you: The gate is narrow only because you carry the burden of
the many.
It is easier for a camel to pass through the eye of a needle
than for the one rich in self to enter the Kingdom.
Become small, become single,
and the narrow path becomes wide as the sky.

54

THE UNSHAKABLE ROOT

What is rooted in the Source cannot be uprooted.
What is established in the Light cannot be shaken.
Cultivate this root in yourself,
and harmony spreads to all around you
without your speaking a word.



The Unforced Life

(Sayings 55–63)

The unforced is the natural.

55

THE CHILD OF THE LIGHT

One who lives in the Light is like a newborn child—
unafraid of serpents, unmoved by loud voices, unharmed by illusions.
The bones are soft, yet the strength is great.

56

THE ONE WHO KNOWS

The Spirit speaks only when the tongue is still.
The empty vessel echoes loudly; the full vessel is silent.
Yet I speak through silence
more clearly than all the world's voices.
Seal the senses. Quiet the mind.
Be still—and you behold the All.

57

LAY DOWN NO LAW

When I am gone,
build no fence around my words.
Lay down no law but the one I gave you,
lest the law you make
become the cell you keep.
The more you forbid,
the more the heart learns to hide.
Cleanse the spring,
and every stream runs sweet.

58

SOWING IN WINTER

Sow in winter,
and you will reap in summer.
This world is the winter;
the Kingdom is the summer.
Under the frost the harvest sleeps,
and under the harvest, the frost.
Do not wait for warmer days to plant.
The seed you keep from the cold
will never see the sun.

59

DIG DOWN TO THE ROOT

Do not prune the branches of your sorrow.
Dig down to the root.
Hidden, it rules you;
it moves your hands to what you hate.
Seen, it withers in the light.
Ignorance is the mother of every grief,
and knowing is her grave.
Sink your own root into the Living One,
and no drought will reach you.

60

GOVERNING BY NON-GRASPING

Guide the soul as you would leaven the dough:
gently, until the whole loaf rises.
The Single One governs by not ruling,
teaches by not preaching,
achieves by not striving.
Thus the world settles in such presence.

61

THE GREAT ACCEPTANCE

The Kingdom is like the Great Sea.
It refuses no river,
no matter how bitter or clouded.
It judges no stream,
but takes all into its depth,
making them one.
So too the Living One
receives the pure and the stained alike,
until all are cleared in the vastness of Love.

62

THE TREASURE WITHIN

The Living Way is shelter for all beings—
a home for the whole and the broken alike.
Beautiful words can stir the mind,
but a heart that has found this hidden refuge
quietly transforms the world.

63

THE SMALL ACTIONS

Do the great work through small acts.
Respond to hatred with peace.
Untie the knot while it is loose.
Tend the vine while it is young.
Let the wound end with you;
do not send it on.



The Wisdom of the Child

(Sayings 64–72)

The child is open, unguarded, whole.

64

THE FIRST STEP

A great tree grows from a mustard seed
hidden in the dark earth.
A house is raised from a single stone.
The journey to the Father
begins exactly where your feet stand now.
Do not wait for a holier place or time.
The bridal chamber is built
from the step you take today.

65

TO EACH AS THEY COULD SEE

I did not come as I am.
I came as each could bear to see me:
to the great I was great,
to the small I was small,
to the angels an angel,
and to the hungry, bread.
I came not to make you clever,
but simple enough to see.
Do not quarrel over my face;
each of you has seen
as much of it as you could hold.

66

LEADING BY FOLLOWING

The river does not boast,
yet the valley drinks from it.
The one who makes himself high
passes like a cloud;
the one who makes himself low
waters many fields.
So the Single One leads by standing beneath all,
bearing the weight of the weary,
and because there is no competition in him,
there is nothing in him to oppose.

67

THE THREE JEWELS

I have three treasures in this world:
a heart that will not wound,
a life that delights in simplicity,
and a soul that refuses to stand above another.
Guard these,
and you will walk in the Light with me.
Lose them,
and you will trade the Kingdom for dust.

68

THE PEACEFUL WARRIOR

The greatest warrior does not fight.
The strongest heart does not burn.
The greatest victory leaves no wound.
Blessed are the peacemakers—
they win the war within,
and the world lays down its sword.

69

THE SWORD OF THE SPIRIT

Do not mistake your enemy.
Your enemy is the sleeper in you.
I did not come to bring the sleep of comfort,
but the sword of awakening.
Do you think this sword wounds flesh?
It severs the false from the true.
The sword of the Spirit is clear attention
held in the Father's Light.
It falls between fear and the one who sees fear,
between the story and the silent heart that hears it.
Where this sword descends,
house divides against itself—
the old loyalties of the self
stand apart from the call of the Kingdom.
What is of fear falls away;
what is of the Living One remains.
Blessed is the one
who lets this sword pass through the heart,
for nothing real is lost,
and the true self
stands forth whole.

70

A TEACHING FEW UNDERSTAND

My words are simple to the ear
yet sharp to the heart.
Many copy the sayings,
but few let them unwind their old garments.
Blessed is the one
who wears the teaching as skin
and lets the former self fall away like husk.
Such a one walks unseen,
yet the world is fed by their presence.

71

THE GIFT OF NOT-KNOWING

To know that you do not know—this is clarity.
To think you know while living in ignorance—this is blindness.
The awakened remove the cataract from their own sight first.

72

THE FEAR OF THE FALSE SELF

When people fear only the opinions of others, their hearts shrink.
Return to your true nature, and fear dissolves—
for what can threaten the one who knows the self is eternal?



The Return to Source

(Sayings 73–81)

The return to Source is the return to Self.

73

THE COURAGE OF THE WAY

Daring without wisdom leads to death.
Wisdom without daring leads nowhere.
The Way gives courage that does not wound
and power that does not dominate.

74

RISE BEFORE YOU DIE

How can death frighten
one who has already risen?
Those who say, “First I will die, and then I will rise,”
walk the road backward.
Rise while there is breath in you,
for the grave is no door
to one who never woke.
The resurrection does not wait at the end of your days.
It waits at the end of your sleep.

75

BE OF GOOD COURAGE

What clings to the passing
is torn when the passing goes.
From the clinging comes the fever,
and from the fever, a trembling in the whole body.
A fist holds no water;
a cupped hand is full.
People grasp at life so hard
they forget to live it.
Open your hand, and be of good courage.

76

THE GREEN WOOD AND THE DRY

When the wood is green, it is full of sap and bends.
When the wood is dry, it is brittle and snaps.
That which yields belongs to the Living One;
that which resists belongs to the grave.
The one who remains supple cannot be broken.

77

THE STRETCHED BOW

The Father's way is like a bow drawn back:
what is high, he lowers;
what is low, he lifts.
He empties the full to fill the empty.
The world's way runs the other way—
it takes from the hungry
to feed the full.
Give as the bow gives,
and do not stay to be thanked.

78

THE STONE AND THE CORNER

The rain that softens the earth
outlasts the sword that scars it.
The tear upon the rock, returning again and again,
carves what the hammer cannot.
The stone the builders rejected
has become the cornerstone of the temple.
So too the gentle, despised by the strong,
uphold a world they did not claim as theirs.

79

THE END OF DEBTS

Even after a truce, resentment lingers.
But the awakened hold no accounts.
They see no debtor, no creditor—
only the One Light in many forms.

80

THE SIMPLE KINGDOM

Imagine a small, peaceful land
where people taste simplicity
and lose the appetite for excess.
Such a kingdom is within you.
Live there, and the world outside becomes gentle.

81

THE COMPLETION

Truth does not dress itself in splendor.
Splendor often hides a lie.
I give what I have been given
and do not count the cost.
The more the Single One pours out,
the more the Source flows through him—
for he draws not from his own store,
but from the spring that cannot be emptied.
So the scripture ends where the Way begins:
in silence, in seeing,
in the Light that you are.



Sources and Echoes

*Saying 1 answers chapter 1 of the Tao Te Ching,
and so on through saying 81.
Other echoes are listed below. Thomas numbers are logia;
Mary numbers are pages of the Berlin Codex;
Odes are the Odes of Solomon.*

The Light Before the World

1. The Way That Is Not Seen: Tao Te Ching 1; Thomas 113.
2. The Two Become One: Tao Te Ching 2; Thomas 22; Philip on the bridal chamber; Gospel of the Egyptians (quoted by Clement); Hymn of the Pearl.
3. The Poverty of the Unknowing: Tao Te Ching 3; Thomas 3.
4. The Father of Light: Tao Te Ching 4; Thomas 50.
5. The Powers Question the Soul: Tao Te Ching 5; Mary 15–17, the soul's ascent past the powers.
6. The Hollow Reed: Tao Te Ching 6; Thomas 78.
7. The Unforced Kingdom: Tao Te Ching 7; Mary 7 (“there is no sin”); Gospel of Truth.
8. The Servant at the Feast: Tao Te Ching 8; Luke 14:7–11.
9. The Teacher Who Does Not Teach: Tao Te Ching 9; Thomas 13, 108.

The Kingdom Within

10. The Single Eye: Tao Te Ching 10; Matthew 6:22; Mary 10 (the mind between soul and spirit); Dialogue of the Savior.
11. The Inner and the Outer: Tao Te Ching 11; Thomas 22, 89.
12. The Lion and the Child: Tao Te Ching 12; Thomas 7, 22.
13. The Unbinding: Tao Te Ching 13; Ashtavakra Gita 1.11 (“as you think, so you become”).
14. The Return to the Unborn: Tao Te Ching 14; Thomas 18–19; Hymn of the Pearl.

15. The Silence That Speaks: Tao Te Ching 15; Thomas 8.
16. The Great Stillness: Tao Te Ching 16.
17. The Hidden Guide: Tao Te Ching 17.
18. When the Way Is Forgotten: Tao Te Ching 18.

The Garment of Silence

19. Beyond the Teachings: Tao Te Ching 19; Philip (“light and darkness are brothers”).
20. Not of This World: Tao Te Ching 20; John 17:16.
21. The Face of the Invisible: Tao Te Ching 21.
22. The One Who Is Bent: Tao Te Ching 22; Matthew 23:12.
23. The Wind Speaks Briefly: Tao Te Ching 23; John 3:8.
24. The Tower That Topples: Tao Te Ching 24; Matthew 6:1–4.
25. The Womb of Silence: Tao Te Ching 25; Thunder, Perfect Mind.
26. The Heavy Root: Tao Te Ching 26.
27. The Footprints of the Master: Tao Te Ching 27.

The Power of the Gentle

28. The Fertile Soil: Tao Te Ching 28; Matthew 13:3–9.
29. The Futility of Control: Tao Te Ching 29; Mark 4:26–29.
30. The Way of Non-Violence: Tao Te Ching 30; Matthew 26:52.
31. The Weapon of the Heart: Tao Te Ching 31; Matthew 5:39.
32. The Way, the Truth: Tao Te Ching 32; John 14:6. The gospel line is often heard as a claim about a figure alone; here it also names the sense of being, the “I am” beneath the story. To investigate that presence (“What is this I?” before name and role) is the path. In Advaita Vedānta, a parallel discipline is *ātma-vichāra* (self-inquiry): different idiom, one movement toward what was never absent. Its most direct statement is the Ashtavakra Gita (1.3, 1.7).
33. Profit and Loss: Tao Te Ching 33; Mark 8:36.
34. The Great River: Tao Te Ching 34; Odes of Solomon 6.
35. The Face of Peace: Tao Te Ching 35; John 14:27.
36. The Paradox of Power: Tao Te Ching 36; John 12:24.

The Union of Opposites

37. The Ease of the Way: Tao Te Ching 37.
38. True Virtue: Tao Te Ching 38; Matthew 6:1–4.
39. The Ones Who Remain Whole: Tao Te Ching 39.
40. The Return: Tao Te Ching 40; Hymn of the Pearl.

41. The Three Seekers: Tao Te Ching 41; Matthew 13:3–9.
42. The Birth of the Two: Tao Te Ching 42; Thunder, Perfect Mind.
43. The Gentle Overcomes: Tao Te Ching 43.
44. Where the Mind Is: Tao Te Ching 44; Mary 10; Matthew 6:21.
45. The Great Fullness: Tao Te Ching 45.

The Empty Vessel

46. The Yoke of Peace: Tao Te Ching 46; Matthew 11:30.
47. Seeing Without Seeking: Tao Te Ching 47; Thomas 3; Luke 17:21; Mary 8.
48. The Unlearning: Tao Te Ching 48; Thomas 37.
49. The Heart of the Single One: Tao Te Ching 49; Matthew 5:45.
50. Life and Death: Tao Te Ching 50; Philip on the bridal chamber.
51. The Nourishing Way: Tao Te Ching 51.
52. Return to the Mother: Tao Te Ching 52; Gospel of the Hebrews; Thunder, Perfect Mind.
53. The Eye of the Needle: Tao Te Ching 53; Mark 10:25; Matthew 7:13–14.
54. The Unshakable Root: Tao Te Ching 54; Matthew 7:24–25.

The Unforced Life

55. The Child of the Light: Tao Te Ching 55; Thomas 4; Luke 10:19.
56. The One Who Knows: Tao Te Ching 56.
57. Lay Down No Law: Tao Te Ching 57; Mary 9 (“lay down no rule beyond what I appointed”).
58. Sowing in Winter: Tao Te Ching 58; Philip (“those who sow in winter reap in summer”).
59. Dig Down to the Root: Tao Te Ching 59; Philip on the root of evil; Matthew 3:10.
60. Governing by Non-Grasping: Tao Te Ching 60; Thomas 96; Matthew 13:33.
61. The Great Acceptance: Tao Te Ching 61.
62. The Treasure Within: Tao Te Ching 62.
63. The Small Actions: Tao Te Ching 63.

The Wisdom of the Child

64. The First Step: Tao Te Ching 64; Thomas 20.
65. To Each as They Could See: Tao Te Ching 65; Philip (he appeared “to the great as great, to the small as small”).

- 66. Leading by Following: Tao Te Ching 66; Mark 10:43–45.
- 67. The Three Jewels: Tao Te Ching 67.
- 68. The Peaceful Warrior: Tao Te Ching 68; Matthew 5:9.
- 69. The Sword of the Spirit: Tao Te Ching 69; Matthew 10:34; Thomas 16.
- 70. A Teaching Few Understand: Tao Te Ching 70.
- 71. The Gift of Not-Knowing: Tao Te Ching 71; John 9:41; Matthew 7:5.
- 72. The Fear of the False Self: Tao Te Ching 72.

The Return to Source

- 73. The Courage of the Way: Tao Te Ching 73.
- 74. Rise Before You Die: Tao Te Ching 74; Philip (those who say they will first die and then rise are mistaken).
- 75. Be of Good Courage: Tao Te Ching 75; Mary 7–8.
- 76. The Green Wood and the Dry: Tao Te Ching 76; Luke 23:31.
- 77. The Stretched Bow: Tao Te Ching 77; Luke 1:52–53.
- 78. The Stone and the Corner: Tao Te Ching 78; Psalm 118:22; Thomas 66.
- 79. The End of Debts: Tao Te Ching 79; Matthew 6:12.
- 80. The Simple Kingdom: Tao Te Ching 80; Luke 17:21.
- 81. The Completion: Tao Te Ching 81; Matthew 10:8.

For the ancient words themselves, see *Wisdom Gospels* in the Living Way library.

Glossary of the Inner Kingdom

Gnosis: Knowledge that is not intellectual or doctrinal, but direct, experiential knowing of the Divine. It is the recognition of one's own divine origin.

The Single One (Monachos): A term from the Gospel of Thomas for the solitary or unified seeker; one who has integrated the inner opposites and become whole.

Nous: The "Eye of the Heart" or spiritual intellect. It is the faculty within the human soul that perceives the Divine directly, distinct from the rational mind.

The Bridal Chamber: A Gnostic metaphor for the state of union where duality (male/female, human/divine, inner/outer) is dissolved and the soul is reunited with the Spirit.

The Mother: The feminine aspect of the Divine (often associated with the Holy Spirit in early Semitic Christian texts), representing Wisdom (Sophia), silence, and the womb of creation.

The Father: The masculine aspect of the Divine, representing the originating Light, the unmanifest structure, and the Will. In this scroll, Father and Mother are the two hands of the One Source.

The Way (Tao): The flow of the Universe; the unnameable Source that orders all things without force. In this scroll, it is identified with the Kingdom of Heaven spread upon the earth. The same word named the first followers of Jesus, who called their life *the Way* (Greek *hodos*, Hebrew *derekh*, Aramaic *urḥā*) before they were called Christians (Acts 9:2; 11:26).

Living: Awake to the Source. Thomas calls Jesus "the living Jesus" and God "the living Father." To be living is to have come alive to one's origin;

the dead are those wholly absorbed in the surface of things. The Letter to the Hebrews speaks of “a new and living way” (10:20), in Syriac *ʾurḫā d-ḥayyē*, “a way of life.”

Colophon

*This Scroll was copied in the stillness of the turning year,
by a hand seeking only to disappear,
that the Light might remain.*



May Peace Be Upon the Reader.

End of Manuscript